

Resurgent force: Rashid Khan rides out the slump — the T20 maestro is finding his spark again. SPORTZPICS/IPL



can't control how much a pitch will turn or behave, but what you can control is your preparation. If you train hard and stay ready for different scenarios, you won't feel out of place even on flat wickets.

If Rashid Khan the batter were facing Rashid Khan the bowler, how would you approach it?

(Laughs) Honestly, I'm not sure how I'd play myself! It really depends on the conditions. You have to assess the wicket and plan accordingly.

If there's some turn, then it becomes difficult for any batter — no matter who it is. When there's something in the surface, whether it's swing or spin, it's much harder for a batter to execute their plans.

But if the pitch is flat and there's no assistance, the batter knows the ball will come on nicely. So, if Rashid the batter is facing Rashid the bowler, he'll have to read the conditions, understand what the pitch is doing, and adjust his game.

Gujarat Titans seem more settled this season. What's been the approach behind the scenes?

We haven't changed much from last year. From day one, Ashish bhai (head coach Ashish Nehra) has kept things simple — and that's been the key. Our plans don't shift based on results. We stick to the process, and everyone is clear about their roles. That clarity has played a big part in our consistency.

We don't overanalyse. Our meetings last no more than 10 minutes, irrespective of the result. There's no panic. The focus is always on effort and execution — giving 200 per cent, regardless of the outcome. That mindset, set by Ashish bhai, has really helped us stay grounded and focused.

Would you say a clear understanding of roles has been key to the team's consistency?

Absolutely. There's no point in